

Family College Budget

FILL IN TOGETHER

What your family can contribute each year without borrowing — worked out calmly, in advance, instead of in the week a deposit is due.

When: Junior year, so there is time to change the plan

What we can put in each year

Source	Per year	Certain or hoped-for?

Sources to consider: savings set aside · 529 or education savings account · monthly amount from income · student’s summer earnings · student’s term-time work · grandparents or other family · employer education benefit.

What we will not do

Deciding this now is what protects you in April.

- ☐ Borrow against the house
- ☐ Stop retirement contributions
- ☐ Take on more than \$_____ in parent loans
- ☐ Let the student borrow more than \$_____ in total

Our number

This is the figure you carry into every conversation with every college.

What our family can pay per year, without borrowing

The most we are willing to borrow per year

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ You cannot borrow for retirement. Your student can borrow for school — that order matters.
- ◆ Tell your student the number. A student who knows it makes a better list.
- ◆ Say it out loud before the acceptances arrive, while it is still a plan and not a disappointment.